



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Thursday, 23rd October, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:12 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we move straight to the item numbered 5, Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

I hold in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 22nd October, 2025.

Page 1...8—

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much for the opportunity. The item numbered 6, under the page in review, that is 6(a), “Gracefield” is supposed to be one word. The school that visited yesterday, Gracefield Basic School, is supposed to be one word. So, the Table Office could take note and correct it accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Clerks-at-the-Table, you may cross-check. But what was brought to me yesterday, appears to be separate words.

Page 9...12—

Yes, Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I was on my feet at page 11, the item numbered 10(b), under Statements, precisely line 4. I pray, Mr Speaker, that the word “he” be replaced with “she”. In other words, we delete “he” and replace with “she”. The Hon Member for Klottey Korle is on record to have made a Statement, so I think the pronoun there should be “she” instead of “he”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are right.

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, the same page, the item numbered 10(c), the very last line, I am wondering if the Clerks-at-the-Table were referring to Backbenchers or Backbench. If you may, I can read—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are right. Table Office, take note.

Page 12...17—

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, just a minor observation, but we do this just to maintain a clean record for the House. Page 17, the item numbered 3(iii), the name “Sarah Grownson” is supposed to

be “Sarah Crownson”. I have done some fact-checking and the correct name is “Crownson” not “Grownson”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table Office, crosscheck the name. Thank you very much, Hon Member.

Page 18—

Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with your guidance, please, page 18, the very first person, that is Mr Kennedy Kludjeson, is supposed to be the Head for Volta and Oti. Since we are dealing with two distinct regions, I think that it should be “Regions”. The Clerks-at-the-Table could add “s” to the word “Region”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Clerks-at-the-Table, please take note.

Page 18.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 22nd October, 2025, as corrected, is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, the *Official Report* dated Friday, 1st August, 2025, under correction. Hon Members, any correction?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 1st August, 2025.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I wish to crave your indulgence to vary the Order of Business so that we can just take the item numbered 8 and call it a day.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Minority Whip?

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, we do not have any objection to that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

At the commencement of public Business, the item numbered 8, Presentation of Papers —

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs is not readily available, but we have the Minister for Roads and Highways here. So, if you could grant him leave to lay the Papers on behalf of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Minority Leader?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the application of the Majority Leader is completely inadequate. He has not provided us the whereabouts of the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs and why the Minister for Roads and Highways should do that instead.

So, Majority Leader, can you indicate to us where your Minister responsible for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs is?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: It would suffice to say that he is unavoidably absent. That is all I can say for now. Same way that my Colleague, the Minority Leader, is unavoidably absent.

2:22 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if the Majority Leader starts this politics—The Minority Leader is not laying any Paper and he is not a Minister of State.

It is the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs who has a Paper to lay. So, Mr Speaker, there is no problem. The Minister for Roads and Highways is always here so, we will allow him, even though, we still have other things to do in our Constituencies; we will allow him to do it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Roads and Highways?

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, we should be improving as a Parliament. We have been operating this Parliament since 1993, and one of the things that we struggle to change as a Parliament has been the fact that when the Executives have Business, it is only at the last minute that the Hon Majority Leader— and this happens on both

Sides; when we were in Government, it was happening and now it is happening. They will come and tell us that the Minister is not present. I think we should find a way of changing this particular thing because the Business of the House is known ahead of time.

So, if a Minister believes that they will not be in Parliament at the time when needed, the Minister needs to communicate it to their Leadership so that the Leadership will communicate it to the other Side and the Speaker so that we do not have this kind of embarrassment that we always have.

We are an arm of government, and we have to find a way; otherwise, the Whips from the Majority Side will have to always inform them that they have a Business and therefore they should make sure they come and lay the Papers and go back. If for some reason they are not there, and they are not able to write officially to seek permission by our procedure, then they would have to let them know.

Otherwise, this practice of always asking people to cover up on the Floor, I think the Hon Majority Leader should find a way of changing it during his time. It is not good for us. It gives the public a certain perception that the House is becoming—I would not use the word second fiddle, but it is not good. When one watches from outside, it is as if what is happening in the House is not important, and that is not good for us. We have to find a way of changing it.

Mr Speaker, remember that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is a good observation.

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, remember that the reason we are sitting at 2 p.m, not 10 a.m, is precisely because of this problem. We all said that we will allow the Ministers to start from 7 o'clock in the morning and work till 1:00 p.m. or 2:00 p.m. so that they can be in Parliament to do Business till 5:00 p.m. and then they can go back and continue. So, if it is still happening, then we would have to either change the time and Sit in the evening, or find some other way out. We need to find some way to resolve this particular problem. It is not good for us.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is a good observation.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Well, that is true to some extent, Mr Speaker. I just want to brief you on what happened at the Business Committee meeting today. The Business was scheduled, we were to approve it, and I asked the Clerks that if they have scheduled the Ministers to come and answer Questions, have they informed them because with the dates they are proposing, it is possible that the Ministers may not actually be available. It turned out that they also deal with the Chief Directors of the Ministers, and then deal with the Schedule Officers at the Ministries responsible for handling questions and enquiries from Parliament. But they hardly deal directly with the Ministers. So, the Ministers will not even

know that they have been scheduled to answer questions on specific days.

So, as a Committee, we said, no, we are going to change this. From today onwards, if we are scheduling Ministers, we have to speak to them directly and let them know that we are scheduling them for these days so that they confirm their availability on those days and then we will schedule them. So, all the Members of the Committee sat there, and we called the Ministers one after the other. Some had travelled to the United States of America, and others were not available. We then juggled with the dates. If a person is not available on Friday, we asked if they would be available of Tuesday and they would say, yes, and so we scheduled all of them for next week based on their own indication of their availability. On those grounds, they will have no excuse for not showing up.

So, we directed the Clerks that henceforth, this is how it would be done. Therefore, they would not advertise anything without having communicated with the Minister on whether he will be present; precisely because of the issues that the Hon Member raised. I said it is not good in the eyes of the public that Ministers are scheduled and then I have to always stand up on my feet and plead on their behalf and ask other Ministers to stand in for them when the truth is that we did not even inform them they have Business in the House that day. So, that is how we did it.

The Hon Minister is here, we called and he confirmed his availability on Thursday to answer all his Questions, so

we scheduled him for Thursday. The Hon Minister for Health said he will not be available on the original date which was on Thursday so we moved him to Tuesday when he said he will be available.

So, I agree with the Hon Member, but we are taking steps to make sure that no Hon Minister is scheduled without the Minister having been given notice himself, not through his staff or Chief Director or the Schedule Officer. So, we will deal with those ones.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Majority Leader.

Hon Members, I believe that once the cause is identified, it is a problem that can be resolved.

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, if he could just do one bow so that we take all of them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

PAPERS

By the Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) on behalf of the Minister for Local government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs —

- i. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Awutu Senya District Assembly for the year 2024.

- ii. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Offinso Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- iii. Risk-Based Internal Audit Work Plan of the Internal Audit Unit of Offinso Municipal Assembly for the period 1st April to 31st December, 2025.
- iv. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bodi District Assembly for the year 2024.
- v. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta Regional Co-ordinating Council for the year 2024.
- vi. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Weija-Gbawe Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- vii. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Wassa Amenfi East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- viii. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kassena Nankana West District Assembly for the year 2024.
- ix. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sekyere Kumawu District Assembly for the year 2024.
- x. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nkwanta South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

- xi. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Savannah Regional Co-ordinating Council for the year 2024.
- xii. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- xiii. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Techiman North District Assembly for the year 2024.
- xiv. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bia West District Assembly for the year 2024.
- xv. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asante Akim South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- xvi. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the North Dayi District Assembly for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Local Government and Rural Development

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, for very good reasons, we will not take any further Business today and crave your indulgence that, pursuant to Order 57, you would adjourn the House until 2:00 p.m. tomorrow.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have any difficulty. We second the Motion for the adjournment until tomorrow at 2 o'clock in the afternoon.

3:32 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Before taking the adjournment, let me acknowledge the presence of students from Pentecost University, Anyaa-Sowutuom led by Rev Augustine Arthur-Norman, lecturer. They are numbered 75.

[Students of Pentecost University were acknowledged]

We also have Covenant Hill led by Ernest Essien, Proprietor, from Nsawam-Adoagyiri and numbered 52.

[Students of Covenant Hill were acknowledged]

We have Domiabra Methodist '2' Basic School led by Selina Abbah, teacher from Domiabra-Obom and numbered 83.

[Pupils of Domiabra Methodist '2' Basic School were acknowledged]

Hon Members, on behalf of the entire House, I welcome our dear students to the Parliament of the Republic of Ghana. May you have a fruitful visit to Parliament.

Hon Members, we have admitted Statements, including a very urgent Statement on the victory of the Black

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

Stars. However, owing to the circumstances, we will defer that Statement till tomorrow.

The House was accordingly adjourned at 2:34 p.m. till Friday, 24th October, 2025 at 2:00 p.m.

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